

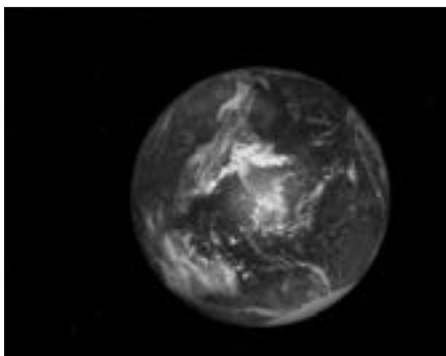
9.1 Celestia

www.shatters.net/celestia/download.html

Celestia is an excellent tool—especially for children—that allows you to navigate the skies. It starts up in a window, and you’ll see Earth in front of a field of stars. When you right-drag the mouse, you’ll be orbiting Earth, and you might see the Moon and some familiar constellations. When you left-drag the mouse, the “camera” rotates about its centre instead of rotating around Earth. Scrolling the mouse wheel will change your distance to Earth: you can move light years away, then roll the wheel back to get back to Earth.

In the program, you can select an object to view. The default object selected is Earth. You can choose to “go to” a star, moon, galaxy, etc.

One of the cool things about Celestia is the way the “camera” zooms back and forth—it’s like a movie! In fact, in the File menu, apart from just capturing screenshots, you can also capture movies.



When the program starts, you see Earth



Navigate to any object in the provided list!